

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

What's It Like to Be a Twin?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	Non-identical twins develop from _____ and share half their genes
2	Identical twins originate from one fertilised egg and share all their _____
3	Examples include queries about psychic abilities, swapping partners and having _____
4	Twins may show annoyance by _____ when asked these questions
5	Currently, one in every _____ is born a twin
6	Being a twin is not always _____
7	However, twins never experience fear during _____
8	Sometimes attend _____ together
9	Important developmental stages are _____ for twins
10	As twins grow older, they realise people view them as a twin rather than an _____
11	Many twins struggle to establish their own _____
12	This debate examines how much of our lives is shaped by _____ we are born with
13	Also considers the impact of _____ we grow up in
14	Because twins share similar genetics, _____ between them provide valuable scientific insights
15	The twins were _____ and grew up in different locations
16	They had remarkably similar _____
17	Both were reunited at age _____

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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18	Both married women named _____ initially
19	Both gave their dogs the name _____
20	The case was described as _____ due to the extraordinary similarities

What is Neil's attitude towards the question he would ask a twin?

- A He considers it a thoughtful and original inquiry
- B He recognises it would likely be irritating to twins
- C He believes it demonstrates scientific curiosity
- D He thinks it reveals genuine concern for twins

According to Anand Jagatia, how might twins respond to common questions about psychic powers?

- A They would answer enthusiastically with personal stories
- B They would appreciate the genuine interest shown
- C They would provide scientific explanations patiently
- D They would display signs of annoyance or frustration

What does Professor Karen Dillon suggest about the early experiences of twins?

- A Shared developmental stages can reduce anxiety during childhood
- B Being in separate classes helps establish individual identities
- C Making friends independently is crucial for their development
- D Fear of social situations is more common among twins

What challenge does Karen Dillon identify for twins as they mature?

- A They struggle to maintain close relationships with each other
- B They find it difficult to share childhood memories
- C They face difficulties being recognised as distinct individuals
- D They experience problems forming friendships with non-twins

Why do scientists find studying twins particularly valuable?

- A Twins provide insights into how personality develops over time
- B Variations between genetically similar individuals reveal environmental influences
- C Twins demonstrate how genetics alone determines life outcomes
- D Identical twins prove that upbringing has minimal impact

What does the case of the Jim Twins primarily illustrate about twins?

- A The powerful influence of genetic factors on life decisions
- B The importance of early childhood separation
- C The role of coincidence in human relationships
- D The benefits of reunion after long separations

What does Anand Jagatia imply when discussing twins separated at birth?

- A Their similar life paths raise questions about personal autonomy
- B Their different choices prove environment matters more than genes
- C Their reunions typically reveal few meaningful similarities
- D Their experiences confirm that genetics play no significant role

What aspect of the Jim Twins' story does Helena De Bres emphasise?

- A The length of time before they were reunited
- B The different environments they grew up in
- C The geographical distance between their homes
- D The remarkable parallels in their life choices

How does Helena De Bres characterise the similarities between the Jim Twins?

- A They were scientifically predictable and expected
- B They were limited to superficial preferences
- C They were extraordinarily unusual and striking
- D They were exaggerated by media reports

What is Beth's overall perspective on the nature of being a twin?

- A It is primarily challenging and problematic
- B It combines unusual and remarkable elements
- C It is scientifically explainable and ordinary
- D It requires more research and investigation